Habits & Actions

PRESENT SIMPLE VS PROGRESSIVE

A Situational Fluency Activity for ESL Students.

The Rules

Comparing general truths and habits with temporary actions happening now.

REFERENCE

Grammar Guide

PRESENT SIMPLE

usually, always, often, every day...

- I/you/we/they + verb
- He/she/it + verb + s/es

PRESENT PROGRESSIVE

now, today, at the moment, Listen!...

- I am + verb-ing
- He/she/it is + verb-ing
- You/we/they are + verb-ing



I usually brew coffee at home, but today I am drinking it in a cafe.

PROGRESSIVE
Simple

Compare the habit and the current action.

HABITS

Usually, always, every day...

```
Subject + base form (+s/es)
```

NOW

Now, today, at the moment...

```
Subject + am/is/are + verb-ing
```



He usually works in an office, but at the moment he is working in the park.

PROGRESSIVE
Simple

HABITS

usually, every morning...

```
Subject + V / V+s
```

NOW

at the moment, today...

```
am/is/are + V-ing
```



They usually take the bus, but today they are riding their bikes to work.

PROGRESSIVE
Simple

HABITS

regularly, on Mondays...

```
Subject + V / V+s
```

NOW

today, this morning...

```
am/is/are + V-ing
```



She usually listens to pop, but tonight she is listening to live jazz.

PROGRESSIVE

Simple

HABITS

usually, sometimes...

```
Subject + V / V+s
```

NOW

tonight, right now...

```
am/is/are + V-ing
```



He usually lifts weights, but today he is practicing yoga.

PROGRESSIVE
Simple

HABITS

three times a week, always...

```
Subject + V / V+s
```

NOW

Look!, this morning...

```
am/is/are + V-ing
```



I usually read books in bed, but this week I am reading on the beach.

PROGRESSIVE
Simple

HABITS

every night...

```
Subject + V / V+s
```

NOW

this week, right now...

```
am/is/are + V-ing
```



PROGRESSIVE
Simple

HABITS

often, generally...

```
Subject + V / V+s
```

NOW

tonight, at the moment...

```
am/is/are + V-ing
```



She usually walks her dog in the park, but now they are playing in the garden.

PROGRESSIVE

Simple

HABITS

every morning...

```
Subject + V / V+s
```

NOW

now, Look!...

```
am/is/are + V-ing
```



He usually studies Spanish, but this semester he is learning French.

PROGRESSIVE
Simple

HABITS

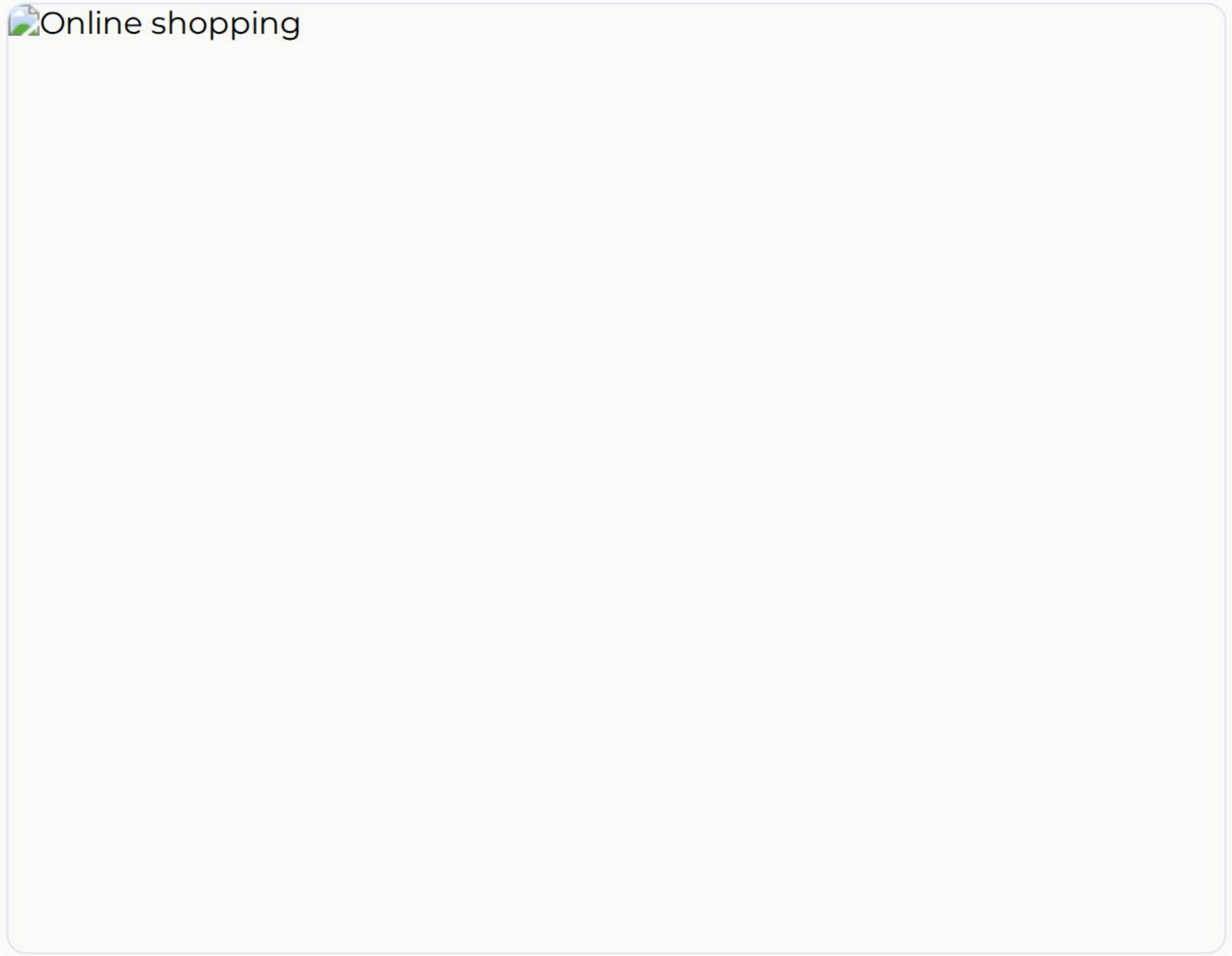
regularly...

```
Subject + V / V+s
```

NOW

this semester, these days...

```
am/is/are + V-ing
```



I usually shop at the mall, but today I am buying clothes online.

PROGRESSIVE
Simple

HABITS

on weekends, often...

```
Subject + V / V+s
```

NOW

today, at the moment...

```
am/is/are + V-ing
```



PROGRESSIVE
Simple

HABITS

sometimes, usually...

```
Subject + V / V+s
```

NOW

Look!, right now...

```
am/is/are + V-ing
```



He usually wakes up at 7:00, but today he is sleeping until 10:00.

PROGRESSIVE

Simple

HABITS

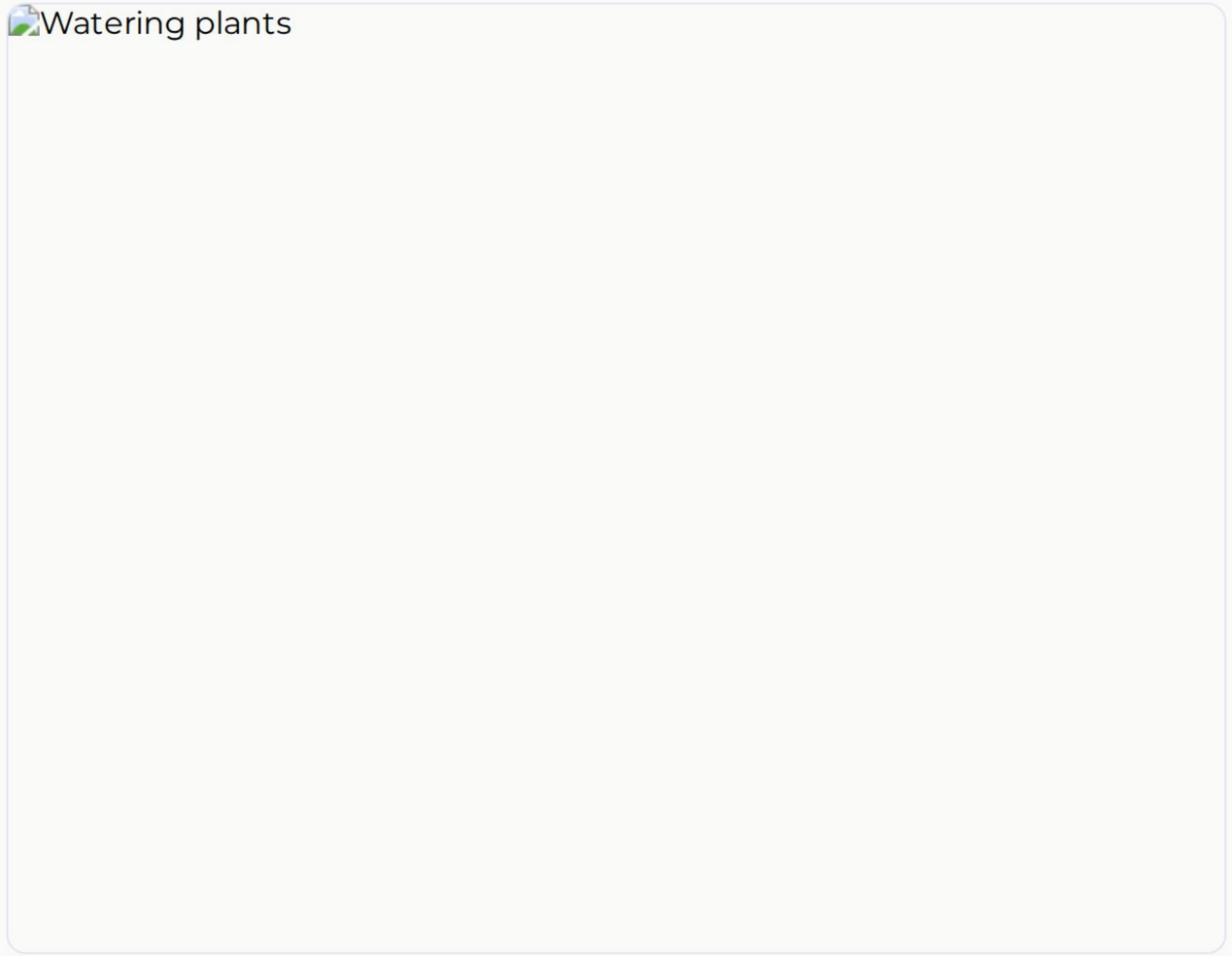
every day, usually...

```
Subject + V / V+s
```

NOW

today, this morning...

```
am/is/are + V-ing
```



They usually vacuum the house, but at the moment they are watering the plants.

PROGRESSIVE
Simple

HABITS

on Saturdays...

```
Subject + V / V+s
```

NOW

now, at the moment...

```
am/is/are + V-ing
```



I usually wear a suit to work, but today I am wearing casual clothes.

PROGRESSIVE

Simple

HABITS

usually, for work...

```
Subject + V / V+s
```

NOW

today, at the moment...

```
am/is/are + V-ing
```



They usually send emails, but now they are having a video call.

PROGRESSIVE
Simple

HABITS

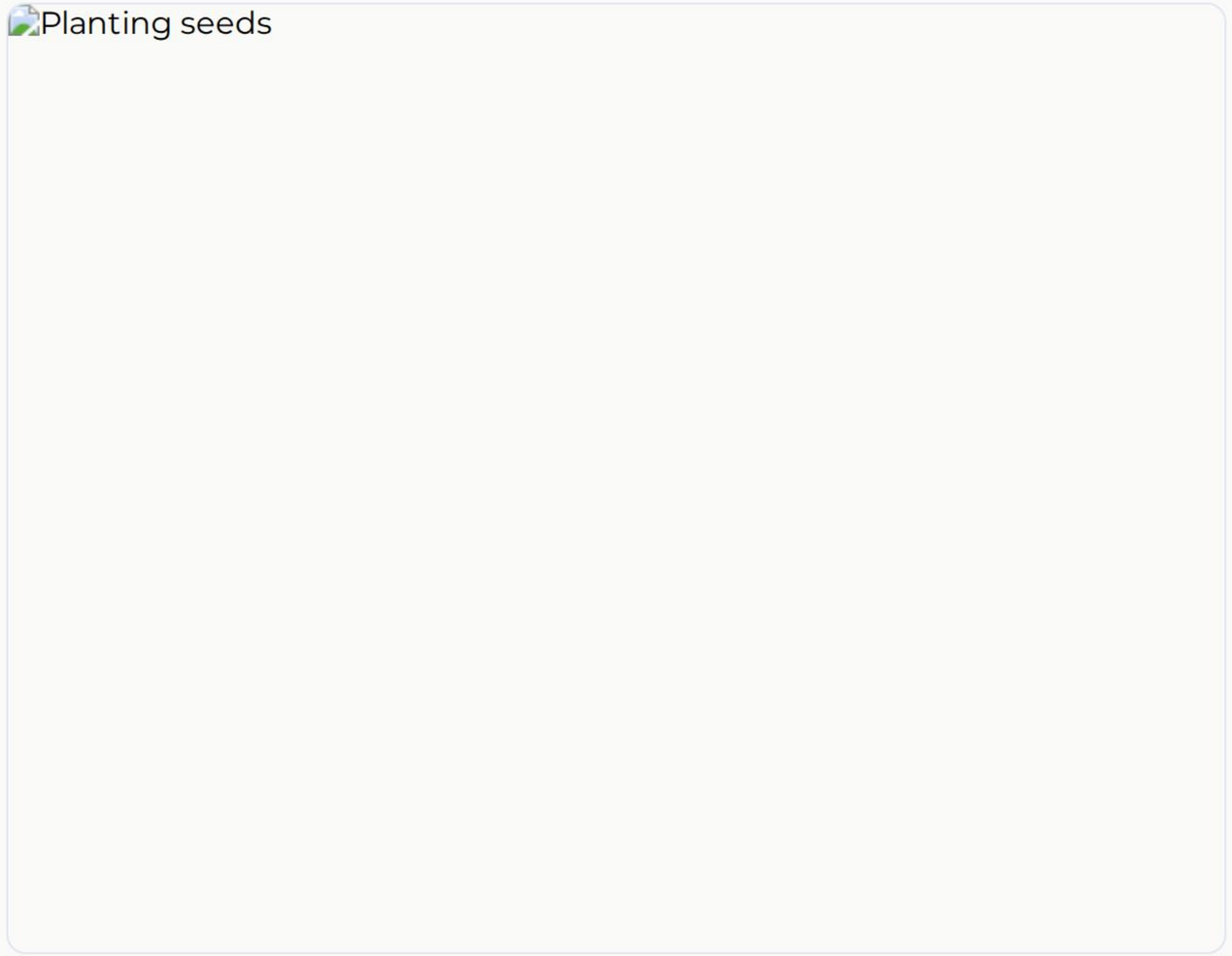
often, generally...

```
Subject + V / V+s
```

NOW

Listen!, now...

```
am/is/are + V-ing
```



She usually mows the lawn, but this morning she is planting seeds.

PROGRESSIVE
Simple

HABITS

on Sundays...

> Subject + V / V+s

NOW

today, this morning...

> am/is/are + V-ing



He usually drives his car, but today he is walking with an umbrella.

PROGRESSIVE

Simple

HABITS

usually, always...

```
Subject + V / V+s
```

NOW

today, Look!...

```
am/is/are + V-ing
```

Well Done!

SESSION WRAP-UP

Practice makes perfect. Use these grammar points when describing your own day!

Image Sources



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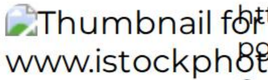
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